

Decision Table Testing

A technique for modeling combinations of conditions and actions in complex business rules.

Structure

List conditions, possible values and actions/results. Each column can represent a relevant rule.

Use

Useful for discounts, permissions, eligibility, shipping, payments and multi-factor rules.

Coverage

Identify valid, impossible and redundant combinations; simplify when conditions are irrelevant.

Test cases

Turn relevant rules into traceable scenarios linked to the business rule.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

When requirements contain many "ifs", a decision table can expose forgotten combinations.